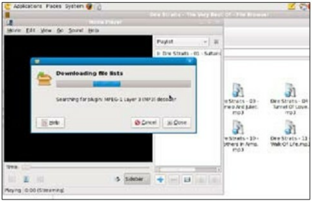

Figure 3: Fedora automatically looks for missing codecs

Back to the desktop

Booting up the brand new system, I notice the flicker-free X server initialisation missing because of being on a system with an NVIDIA chipset. The good thing is Fedora now uses the free Nouveau drivers for NVIDIA instead of NV—we all knew how unreliable NV was, right? I remember Fedora 10 live CD won't even start the X server; F11, on the other hand, even lets me use the maximum resolution of 1280x1028 using Nouveau.

Oh yes, the DVD installation gave me a more complete GNOME desktop, including OOo and F-Spot. Talking about OOo, its icons are still the ones that appeared with the release of Red Hat 8 back in 2002, and they are ugly.

Anyway, time to see what else is there on the DVD. Alas, the PackageKit/Yum interface doesn't include the DVD as a source by default and expects you to download the packages even if they are available on the DVD. Talk about waste of bandwidth and time. What's worse, the GUI doesn't give you an option to add it. Heck, even a simple option to add a proxy is missing.

The only option it lets you have control over is checking boxes to enable/disable the repositories. I understand this is adequate if you're only interested in adding third-party repos like RPM Fusion. You can simply head over to the website and install the RPMs for free and non-free repos, and it will automagically configure and enable the repos in your sources. But what if you're behind a proxy or want to add the DVD as a source? Well, then you've got to manually edit some files.

Here's how you add the DVD as a source—as root, create a file called */etc/yum.repos.d/fedora-dvd.repo* and enter the following text in it:

```
[fedora-dvd]
name=Fedora 11 DVD
baseurl=file:///media/Fedora%2011%20i386%20DVD/
enabled=1
gpgcheck=0
```

That's it! Now the package manager is intelligent enough to not download the packages that are already on the DVD.

NVIDIA blues

On my home-brewed system I'm stuck with an NVIDIA integrated graphics card. Now, unlike other distros, Fedora doesn't officially support proprietary drivers, and naturally, there's no non-free repo to be had. Under the circumstances, RPM Fusion comes to the rescue.

I installed the *kmod-nvidia-185.14.18-1* package (a metapackage with tracks nvidia kernel modules for newest kernels) and restarted X. My resolution went back to 1024x768 from 1280x1024. Up on trying to launch the *system-config-display* tool from the command line, I got the following error:

```
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "/usr/share/system-config-display/xconf.py", line 376, in <module>
    dialog = xConfigDialog.XConfigDialog(hardware_state, xconfig, rhpxl.
videocard.VideoCardInfo())
  File "/usr/share/system-config-display/xConfigDialog.py", line 641, in
__init__
    if len(self.xconfig.layout[0].adjacencies) > 1:
IndexError: index out-of-bounds
```

Up on searching the Web, I found a bug report at *bugzilla.redhat.com/show_bug.cgi?id=493680*. Solution from the Fedora forum [*forums.fedoraforum.org/showthread.php?t=206931*] that I got was to delete the */etc/X11/xorg.conf* file and then launch *system-config-display*. Although it loads up now, it doesn't allow me to go beyond 1024x764 px.

Switching from init 5 to init 3, and launching *system-config-display* lets me change the resolution back to 1280x1024 px, but back on the desktop Compiz reports 3D isn't supported.

Up on various trial-and-errors and being still unable to resolve it, I thought I was better off with the free Nouveau drivers.

And here's how you set up Yum/PackageKit to use a proxy—append the following text in the */etc/yum.conf* file:

```
#The proxy server - proxy server:port number
proxy=http://MyProxyURL:PortNumber
#The proxy user name and password
proxy_username=MyUserName
proxy_password=MyPassword
```

Of course, fill in your appropriate proxy URL/IP, port number, user name and password details above.

So, the first thing I did was install the Echo icon theme. Although, it's not a finished product, it's still gorgeous! Next thing was to test how the auto mime installation works. I headed over to my music folder and double clicked on an mp3 file. It automatically prompted me to press 'Search' to look for appropriate codecs, and returned *gstreamer-ugly-plugins* soon. Somehow, I wasn't so lucky with AVI files.

Still on the subject of PackageKit and Yum, I think it's rather slow in figuring out dependencies or even searching packages. I'm sure those from the *apt-get* wonderland